

Basic Topology

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Topological spaces

TODO

Change all $\subseteq$ into $\subset$ (for clearer notation).

Make header better.

Make numbers of theorem environments incremental together instead of a counter per environment.

Natural numbers do not contain zero.

1.1 Topologies and bases

Definition 1.1.1: Topological space

A **topological space** is a pair (X, τ) where X is a nonempty set and τ is a family of subsets of X , such that:

1. $X, \emptyset \in \tau$.
2. Any arbitrary union of elements of τ is again in τ .
3. Any finite intersection of elements of τ is again in τ .

The set τ is called a **topology** over X . Subsets of X which are in τ are called **open** in X and sets which their complement is in τ are called **closed** in X .

Note that a topology τ is never empty by axiom 1 in our definition. Generally, if the topology is clear we simply refer to the topological space as the set X , understanding that we are working with an implicit topology.

Example 1.1.1. Over any nonempty set X we can define the **discrete topology** by taking $\tau = \wp(X)$, where $\wp(X)$ is the set of all subsets of X (the power set of X). It is easily checked that this satisfies every axiom of a topology.

Example 1.1.2. $\tau = \{X, \emptyset\}$ is also a topology over X , called the **trivial topology**.

Example 1.1.3. Given a point $p \in X$ in a nonempty set X we can define the **special point topology** by taking $\tau = \{A \subseteq X : p \in A\} \cup \{\emptyset\}$.

Example 1.1.4. For a more interesting example, we can consider over the real numbers the topology $\tau = \{A \subseteq \mathbb{R} : \forall x \in A \exists I \text{ open interval s.t. } x \in I \subseteq A\}$. This one is called the **euclidean topology** over the real numbers. As it is quite ubiquitous, whenever we talk about the real numbers without explicitly mentioning the topology we will assume they carry the euclidean topology.

Definition 1.1.2: Comparison of topologies

Let X be a nonempty set and let τ_1 and τ_2 be two topologies over X . If $\tau_1 \subseteq \tau_2$ we say that τ_2 is **finer** than τ_1 and that τ_1 is **thicker** than τ_2 .

The first problem that we have is finding non trivial topologies. For that purpose, we introduce the concept of a base.

Definition 1.1.3: Base

Let X be a nonempty set. $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \wp(X)$ is called a **base** (for a topology) over X if

1. $\bigcup_{B \in \mathcal{B}} B = X$.
2. For every $B_1, B_2 \in \mathcal{B}$ with nonempty intersection and $x \in B_1 \cap B_2$ there exists a $B_3 \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B_3 \subseteq B_1 \cap B_2$.

An element of a base is called a **basic element**.

It is easily checked that condition 2 implies that when given a finite number of basic elements with nonempty intersection and x in that intersection, there exists some other basic element that is between x and the intersection, check exercise (1.1).

Bases will allow us to characterize topological concepts using a family of sets much smaller than the family of open sets. First, we see how we can get a topology from a base.

Theorem 1.1.1. Let X be a nonempty set and $\mathcal{B}$ a base over X . The set

$$\tau_{\mathcal{B}} = \{O \subseteq X : \forall x \in O \exists B \in \mathcal{B} \text{ s.t. } x \in B \subseteq O\}$$

is a topology over X , called the **topology generated** by $\mathcal{B}$. Moreover, if τ' is another topology such that $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \tau'$ then $\tau_{\mathcal{B}} \subseteq \tau'$ (that is to say $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ is the smallest topology that contains $\mathcal{B}$).

Proof. We first have to check that $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ satisfies the axioms for a topology.

1. $\emptyset \in \tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ trivially and $X \in \tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ because of $\bigcup_{B \in \mathcal{B}} B = X$
2. Let $\{U_i\}_{i \in I}$ be an arbitrary family of sets in $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$, and let $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$. If $x \in U$ then x is in at least one U_i , so there exists $B \in \tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ with $x \in B \subset U_i \subset U$ and so $U \in \tau_{\mathcal{B}}$.
3. Let $\{U_i\}_{i=1}^n$ be a finite family of sets in $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$, and let $U = \bigcap_{i=1}^n U_i$. If U is empty, then $U \in \tau_{\mathcal{B}}$. If U is non-empty, and if $x \in U$ then x is in every U_i and because of exercise (1.1) there exists a $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B \subset U$ and so U is in $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ by definition.

So $\tau_{\mathcal{B}}$ is a topology. The second part of the theorem is a consequence of the next theorem. $\square$

Theorem 1.1.2. Let X be a nonempty set and $\mathcal{B}$ a base over X . Then the topology generated by $\mathcal{B}$ is equal to the set of all possible unions of elements of $\mathcal{B}$ (taking the empty union to equal the empty set).

Proof. $\square$

Example 1.1.5. The euclidean topology of example (1.1.4) is generated by the base $\mathcal{B}$ consisting of all open intervals, that is sets of the form $]a, b[= \{x \in \mathbb{R} : a < x < b\}$.

Now that we know how to get a topology from a base, it's convenient to be able to get a base from a topology.

Theorem 1.1.3. TODO: See if it's correct Let (X, τ) be a topological space, and $\mathcal{B} \subseteq \wp(X)$ a set of subsets of X . Then $\mathcal{B}$ is a base for τ if and only if $\forall O \in \tau$ and $\forall x \in O$ there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B \subseteq O$.

And finally, we have a result for comparing the topologies generated by two bases.

Theorem 1.1.4 (Hausdorff Criterion). Let X be a nonempty set and $\mathcal{B}_1, \mathcal{B}_2$ two bases over X . If for every $B_1 \in \mathcal{B}_1$ and every $x \in B_1$ there exists $B_2 \in \mathcal{B}_2$ such that $x \in B_2 \subseteq B_1$ then $\tau_{\mathcal{B}_1} \subseteq \tau_{\mathcal{B}_2}$.

We now introduce the concept of a subbase, a generalization of a base.

Definition 1.1.4: Subbase

Let X be a nonempty set. A family of sets δ of X is called a **subbase** for a topology over X if the union of every set in δ equals X .

Theorem 1.1.5. Let X be a nonempty set, and δ a subbase over X . Then the arbitrary union of finite intersections of sets in δ form the smallest topology that contains δ , such a topology is called the **topology generated** by δ .

This theorem is the important thing for subbases: they are almost arbitrary families of sets of X , and they provide a way of talking about the smallest topology that contains them.

Definition 1.1.5: Neighborhood

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $x \in X$. A subset $U \subseteq X$ is called a **neighborhood** if there exists $O \in \tau$ such that $x \in O \subseteq U$. If U is then open, it's called an **open neighborhood**, and if U is an element of some base, it's called a **basic neighborhood**. We denote the set of all neighborhoods of x with $\mathcal{N}(x)$.

Definition 1.1.6: Neighborhood base

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $x \in X$. A set $\mathcal{B}$ of subsets of X is called a **neighborhood base** if

1. Every element of $\mathcal{B}$ is a neighborhood of x .
2. For every neighborhood U of x there exists $B \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B \subseteq U$.

1.2 Closed and open sets

Open and closed sets are important in the definition of a topology. It's no wonder that we study some of their properties.

First, we see that closed sets satisfy properties similar to that of open sets.

Theorem 1.2.1. Let (X, τ) be a topological space. Then the set $\mathcal{F}$ of closed sets of (X, τ) satisfy:

1. $X, \emptyset \in \mathcal{F}$.
2. Any finite union of elements of $\mathcal{F}$ is again in $\mathcal{F}$.

3. Any arbitrary intersection of elements of $\mathcal{F}$ is again in $\mathcal{F}$.

We can also define a topology via a family of sets that satisfy the conditions in theorem (1.2.1), see exercise .

Definition 1.2.1: Closure

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. We define the **closure** of A to be the intersection of all closed subsets of X that contain A , and denote it by $\text{Cl}(A)$.

In the definition of closure we assume that the intersection of a bounded below by inclusion subset of closed sets exists, but this is always true due to item 3 in theorem (1.2.1). The closure of a nonempty set A is nonempty as there will always be a closed set containing A (the set X), so the family of closed subsets containing A will be nonempty, and the intersection of all closed sets that contain A will, inevitably, contain A .

Definition 1.2.2: Limit and accumulation point

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. $p \in X$ is said to be a **limit point** of a nonempty set $A \subseteq X$ if all neighborhoods of p intersect A . If all neighborhoods of p intersect $A \setminus \{p\}$ then p is said to be an **accumulation point** of A .

Definition 1.2.3: Isolated point

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. $p \in X$ is said to be an **isolated point** of a nonempty set $A \subseteq X$ if $p \in A$ and there exists a neighborhood U of x such that $U \cap A = \{p\}$.

Definition 1.2.4: Interior and exterior

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. We define the **interior** of A to be the union of all open subsets of X contained in A , and denote it by $\text{Int } A$. The **exterior** of A is defined as $\text{Ext}(A) = \text{Int}(X \setminus A)$.

Definition 1.2.5: Interior and exterior point

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. $p \in X$ is said to be an **interior point** of a nonempty set $A \subseteq X$ if A is a neighborhood of p . If instead $X \setminus A$ is a neighborhood of p , p is said to be an **exterior point** of A .

An interior point of a subset is also a limit point of the same subset. It may be believed that an interior point is also an accumulation point, but this is not always true:

Example 1.2.1. Consider the set $X = \{a, b, c\}$ with a, b, c all distinct, and consider the discrete topology over X . Then, if $A = \{a, b\}$ it is easily checked that a is an interior point of A because $\{a\}$ is open, but it is not an accumulation point because the open neighborhood $\{a\}$ of a doesn't intersect $A \setminus \{a\} = \{b\}$.

Definition 1.2.6: Boundary

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. We define the **boundary** (or frontier) of A to be $\text{Fr}(A) = \text{Cl}(A) \setminus \text{Int}(A)$, and a point inside the boundary of A is called a **boundary point**.

Theorem 1.2.2. Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. Then:

1. $\text{Int}(A)$ is equal to the biggest open set that is contained in A .
2. $\text{Cl}(A)$ is equal to the smallest closed set that contains A .

Theorem 1.2.3. Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$.

1. A is open if and only if $\text{Int}(A) = A$. That is to say, A is open if and only if it's a neighborhood of every point inside it.
2. A is closed if and only if $\text{Cl}(A) = A$.

Theorem 1.2.4. Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. Then:

1. $\text{Int}(A)$ is equal to the set of all interior points of A .
2. $\text{Cl}(A)$ is equal to the set of all limit points of A .
3. $\text{Ext}(A)$ is equal to the set of all exterior points of A .

Theorem 1.2.5. Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A, B \subseteq X$.

1. If $A \subseteq B$ then $\text{Cl}(A) \subseteq \text{Cl}(B)$ and $\text{Int } A \subseteq \text{Int } B$. Nothing can be said for the boundary.
2. $\text{Cl}(A) \cup \text{Cl}(B) = \text{Cl}(A \cup B)$ and $\text{Int } A \cup \text{Int } B \subseteq \text{Int } A \cup B$.
3. $\text{Cl}(A) \cap \text{Cl}(B) \supseteq \text{Cl}(A \cap B)$ and $\text{Int } A \cap \text{Int } B = \text{Int } A \cap B$.
4. $\text{Int}(A) = X \setminus \text{Cl}(X \setminus A)$.

Theorem 1.2.6. Let (X, τ) be a topological space. If $A \subseteq X$, then

$$X = \text{Int}(A) \cup \text{Fr}(A) \cup \text{Ext}(A).$$

We can also characterize previous definitions via bases and neighborhood bases.

Theorem 1.2.7. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $\mathcal{B}$ a base for τ and $A \subseteq X$. If $p \in X$, then

1. p is a limit point of A if and only if every basic neighborhood of p intersects A .
2. p is an interior point of A if and only if there exists some basic neighborhood of p contained in A .
3. p is a boundary point of A if and only if every basic neighborhood of p intersects A and $X \setminus A$.
4. p is an accumulation point of A if and only if every basic neighborhood of p intersects A at a point different from p .
5. p is an isolated point of A if and only if $p \in A$ and there exists some basic neighborhood of p that doesn't contain any other points of A .

Theorem 1.2.8. Let (X, τ) be a topological space and $A \subseteq X$. If $p \in X$ and $\mathcal{B}(p)$ is a neighborhood base for p , then

1. p is a limit point of A if and only if every element of $\mathcal{B}(p)$ intersects A .
2. p is an interior point of A if and only if there exists some element of $\mathcal{B}(p)$ contained in A .
3. p is a boundary point of A if and only if every element of $\mathcal{B}(p)$ intersects A and $X \setminus A$.
4. p is an accumulation point of A if and only if every element of $\mathcal{B}(p)$ intersects A at a point different from p .
5. p is an isolated point of A if and only if $p \in A$ and there exists element of $\mathcal{B}(p)$ that doesn't contain any other points of A .

Finally, we define dense subsets.

Definition 1.2.7: Dense subset

If $S \subset X$ is a subset of a space X such that $\text{Cl}(S) = X$ then S is called a **dense** subset of X .

Theorem 1.2.9. $S \subset X$ is dense if and only if every open set of X intersects S .

1.3 Subspaces

Definition 1.3.1: Subspace topology

Let (X, τ) be a topological space, and $A \subseteq X$ nonempty. We define the **subspace topology**

$$\tau_A = \{O \cap A : O \in \tau\}.$$

The resulting topological space (A, τ_A) is called a **subspace** of X .

Theorem 1.3.1. The set defined in definition 1.3.1 is a topology over A .

Note that we may equip a subset of a topological space with any topology we want, but that doesn't make it a subspace. The subspace topology is important as it is the one that “makes” sense to put on a subset, as if A is an open set then $\tau_A \subseteq \tau$. We sometimes just refer to the subspace (A, τ_A) as A , just as with spaces.

Theorem 1.3.2. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, and $A \subseteq X$ nonempty. The set of closed sets $\mathcal{F}_A$ of the space (A, τ_A) is

$$\mathcal{F}_A = \{C \cap A : C \in \mathcal{F}\}.$$

We have to be careful when using the vocabulary of the last two sections in relation to subspaces. It may happen that a set is open in A , but not be open in X , or be closed in A and not be in X , or viceversa:

Example 1.3.1.

We can however guarantee stronger transitivity under certain conditions:

Theorem 1.3.3. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, and $A \subseteq X$ nonempty. Then

1. If A is open in X , then $B \subseteq A$ is open in A iff B is open in X .
2. If A is closed in X , then $B \subseteq A$ is closed in A iff B is closed in X .

This is a crude explanation of why open and closed subspaces are more interesting than other subspaces, more reasons will be given in the topological invariants chapter. For now, we will give properties of subspaces related to the parent space.

Theorem 1.3.4. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $\mathcal{B}$ a base for τ and $A \subseteq X$ nonempty. Then

$$\mathcal{B}_A = \{B \cap A : B \in \mathcal{B}\}$$

is a base for the subspace topology over A .

Theorem 1.3.5. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $A \subseteq X$ nonempty and $x \in A$. Then

$$\mathcal{N}_A(x) = \{U \cap A : U \in \mathcal{N}(x)\}$$

is the family of neighborhoods of x in (A, τ_A) .

Theorem 1.3.6. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $A \subseteq X$ nonempty, $x \in A$ and $\mathcal{B}(x)$ a neighborhood base for x in X . Then

$$\mathcal{B}_A(x) = \{B \cap A : B \in \mathcal{B}(x)\}$$

is a neighborhood base of x in (A, τ_A) .

We can also talk about the closure, interior, exterior and boundary of a set inside a subspace. For notational convenience, in the corresponding operators we use a subscript to indicate which space we are talking about when there could be confusion: for example, if $S \subseteq A \subseteq X$ the closure of S inside A would be denoted by $\text{Cl}_A(S)$, meanwhile if Y is a topological space which is disjoint from X the closure of a subset H of Y shall be denoted by $\text{Cl}(H)$, as there can be no confusion of which space we are in.

Theorem 1.3.7. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $A \subseteq X$ nonempty and $S \subseteq A$. Then

$$\text{Cl}_A(S) = \text{Cl}(S) \cap A.$$

This is quite nice compared to the cases of the interior and the boundary: TODO: Are they correct?

Theorem 1.3.8. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $A \subseteq X$ nonempty and $S \subseteq A$. Then

$$\text{Int}(S) \cap A \subseteq \text{Int}_A(S).$$

If A is open, then the inclusion turns into equality.

Theorem 1.3.9. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, $A \subseteq X$ nonempty and $S \subseteq A$. Then

$$\text{Fr}_A(S) \subseteq \text{Fr}(S) \cap A.$$

The inclusion in theorem (1.3.8) is not always an equality:

Example 1.3.2. In the real numbers over the euclidean topology, consider the set of rational numbers $A = \mathbb{Q}$. Then

$$\text{Int}(A) = \emptyset$$

but

$$\text{Int}_A(A) = A$$

so

$$\text{Int}(A) \cap A = \emptyset \subsetneq \text{Int}_A(A) = \mathbb{Q}.$$

1.4 Continuous functions

Definition 1.4.1: Continuous function

Let (X, τ) and (Y, τ') be topological spaces. An application $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is **continuous** with respect to the topologies τ and τ' if for every $O \in \tau'$ we have $f^{-1}(O) \in \tau$. When talking about applications between topological spaces, we denote them by $f : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$.

Theorem 1.4.1. A function is continuous if and only if the preimage of every closed set is closed.

This is a global definition. We can also talk about continuity locally or near points:

Definition 1.4.2: Continuity at a point

A function $f : X \rightarrow Y$ between spaces is called **continuous at a point** $x_0 \in X$ if for all $U \in \mathcal{N}(f(x_0))$ there exists some $V \in \mathcal{N}(x_0)$ such that $f(V) \subset U$.

Theorem 1.4.2. A function is continuous if and only if it's continuous at every point.

We can also characterize continuity via bases and neighborhood bases.

Theorem 1.4.3. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a function between spaces and $x_0 \in X$. Let $\mathcal{B}(x_0)$ and $\mathcal{B}(f(x_0))$ be neighborhood bases of x_0 and $f(x_0)$ respectively. Then f is continuous at x_0 if and only if for all $B' \in \mathcal{B}(f(x_0))$ there exists some $B \in \mathcal{B}(x_0)$ such that $f(B) \subset B'$.

Theorem 1.4.4. If $g : X \rightarrow Y$ and $f : Y \rightarrow Z$ are continuous at $x_0 \in X$ and $g(x_0)$ respectively then their composition $f \circ g$ is continuous at x_0 .

Theorem 1.4.5. The composition of continous functions is continuous.

TODO: Put the big characterization theorem here

Definition 1.4.3: Open function

A function $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is called **open** if the image of every open set is open.

Definition 1.4.4: Closed function

A function $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is called **closed** if the image of every closed set is closed.

1.5 Product spaces

Theorem 1.5.1 (Embedding lemma). Let X be a space and F be a family of continuous functions of the form $f : X \rightarrow Y_f$. Then the evaluation mapping given by $e : X \rightarrow \prod Y_f$ and

$$(e(x))_f = f(x) \quad \forall x \in X \quad \forall f \in F$$

is an embedding if and only if F distinguishes points and F distinguishes points and closed sets.

1.6 Terminal topologies**Definition 1.6.1: Quotient space**

Let (X, τ) be a topological space and let $\sim$ be an equivalence binary relation (ERB). We define over the quotient set $X/\sim$ the **quotient topology**

$$\tilde{\tau} = \{O \subseteq X/\sim : p^{-1}(O) \in \tau\}$$

(which is indeed a topology). The space $(X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ is called the **quotient space** of (X, τ) under $\sim$. The application $p : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ defined by $p(x) = [x]$ for all $x \in X$ is called the **canonical projection**.

Theorem 1.6.1. The set $\tilde{\tau}$ defined in (1.6.1) is a topology, and it is the finest topology for which the canonical projection $p : X \rightarrow X/\sim$ is continuous.

Proof. It is obvious that $p : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ is continuous. Now, let τ' be any other topology over $X/\sim$ in which p is continuous. Then for every $O' \in \tau'$ we have $p^{-1}(O') \in \tau$, which means $O' \in \tilde{\tau}$ and so $\tau' \subseteq \tilde{\tau}$. $\square$

Theorem 1.6.2. A function $f : (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau}) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ of a quotient space onto a topological space is continuous if and only if $f \circ p : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ is continuous.

Proof. If f is continuous, then $f \circ p$ is a composition of continuous functions, so it is continuous. Now, suppose $f \circ p$ is continuous for some $f : (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau}) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$. If $O' \in \tau'$ then $(f \circ p)^{-1}(O') \in \tau$, but it is known that for preimages $\tau \ni (f \circ p)^{-1}(O') = (p^{-1} \circ f^{-1})(O') = p^{-1}(f^{-1}(O'))$ and by definition of the quotient topology $f^{-1}(O') \in \tilde{\tau}$, so f is continuous. $\square$

Theorem 1.6.3. The family of closed sets of $(X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ is exactly

$$\tilde{\mathcal{F}} = \{C \subseteq X/\sim : p^{-1}(C) \text{ is closed in } X\}.$$

Definition 1.6.2: Saturated set

A set $S \subseteq X$ is called **saturated with respect to $\sim$** (or simply saturated) if

$$S = p^{-1}(p(S)).$$

We denote the set of all saturated subsets of X by $\text{sats}(X)$ (whenever the EBR is clear). Given $S \subset X$, the **saturation** of S is defined as

$$p^{-1}(p(S)).$$

Theorem 1.6.4. A set $S \subseteq X$ is saturated if and only if it's an union of equivalence classes.

Theorem 1.6.5.

$$\text{sats}(X) = \{p^{-1}(p(S)) : S \subseteq X\}$$

Theorem 1.6.6. Arbitrary unions and arbitrary intersections of saturated sets are saturated (with respect to the same EBR). Moreover, $X \in \text{sats}(X)$ and $\emptyset \in \text{sats}(X)$, so $\text{sats}(X)$ is a topology over X .

Theorem 1.6.7. Open sets in $X/\sim$ are exactly projections of open saturated sets,

$$\tilde{\tau} = p(\text{sats}(X) \cap \tau),$$

and closed sets in $X/\sim$ are exactly projections of closed saturated sets,

$$\tilde{\mathcal{F}} = p(\text{sats}(X) \cap \mathcal{F}).$$

These results lead neatly to a characterization of when is the projection open or closed. TODO: Characterization of open or closed for functions quotient to other space.

Theorem 1.6.8. Wrong?

- The canonical projection X is open if and only if the saturation of every open set in τ is open.
- The canonical projection X is closed if and only if the saturation of every closed set in τ is closed.

Theorem 1.6.9. For all $x \in X$

$$\mathcal{N}([x]) = p(\{U \in \text{sats}(X) \mid \exists O_x \in \tau \cap \mathcal{N}(x) \cap \text{sats}(X) \text{ with } x \in O_x \subseteq U\}),$$

which is a well defined set.

Theorem 1.6.10. $(X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ is T1 if and only if every equivalence class is closed in (X, τ) .

Proof. By characterization of T1, □

Theorem 1.6.11. $(X/\sim, \tilde{\tau})$ is Hausdorff if and only if for every $x, y \in X$ with $x \not\sim y$ there exist saturated sets $O_x \in \tau \cap \mathcal{N}(x)$ and $O_y \in \tau \cap \mathcal{N}(y)$ such that $O_x \cap O_y = \emptyset$.

This condition is hardly operative.

One thing we may want is to find a space easier to work with that is homeomorphic to our quotient space.

Theorem 1.6.12. Let $g : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ be a continuous surjective function that induces an application f on the quotient set $X/\sim$. If for all $O \subseteq Y$ we have that $g^{-1}(O) \in \tau$ implies $O \in \tau'$ then the application $f : (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau}) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ is a homeomorphism.

Now, we can also understand an EBR over X as a surjective function over some other set, Y and viceversa:

Theorem 1.6.13. Let X and Y be nonempty sets and $g : X \rightarrow Y$ a surjective application. Defining an EBR $\sim$ on X by

$$x \sim y \text{ iff } g(x) = g(y)$$

we get that g induces a map on the quotient, $\tilde{g} : (X/\sim) \rightarrow Y$ which is a bijection. Also, for all $y \in Y$ we have $g^{-1}(y) = [x]$ for all $x \in g^{-1}(y)$.

If over some set X we have an EBR $\sim$, this EBR uniquely defines the surjective application of projection over the quotient. This two results are purely set theoretical, and lead to an alternate definition of quotient topology, one more general using surjective functions:

Theorem 1.6.14. Let (X, τ) be a topological space, Y be a nonempty set and $g : X \rightarrow Y$ a surjective application. If we define a topology τ' over Y by

$$\tau' = \{O' \subseteq Y \mid g^{-1}(O') \in \tau\}$$

and an EBR $\sim$ on X by

$$x \sim y \text{ iff } g(x) = g(y)$$

we get that g induces a map of spaces on the quotient, $\tilde{g} : (X/\sim, \tilde{\tau}) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ which is a homeomorphism.

TODO: Kolmogorov, T1 and Hausdorff quotients

1.7 Problems and exercises

I have decided to compile interesting or useful exercises in this section. It is of note that they are not ordered in any way other than the order of the sections, and that I have not cared for the pedagogical value they provide so some may be too hard or others too easy. They also serve to fill in some easier proofs that are not provided in the main text.

Exercise 1.1. Prove from the definition of a base that if $\{B_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a finite family of elements in some base $\mathcal{B}$ that have nonempty intersection then if $x \in B = \bigcap_{i \in I} B_i$ there exists some $B' \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $x \in B' \subset B$.

Exercise 1.2. Let X be a nonempty set and $f : \wp(X) \rightarrow \wp(X)$ an application that satisfies:

1. $f(\emptyset) = \emptyset$.
2. $f(f(A)) = f(A)$ for all $A \subseteq X$.

3. $A \subseteq f(A)$ for all $A \subseteq X$.

4. If $A, B \subseteq X$ then $f(A \cup B) = f(A) \cup f(B)$.

Show that the set $\mathcal{F} = \{A \subseteq X \mid A = f(A)\}$ is the closed sets of a topology such that $\text{Cl}(A) = f(A)$ for all $A \subseteq X$. Maps that satisfy the previous axioms are called **Kuratowski closure operators**.

Exercise 1.3. Find a map $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that there exists $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$ with $f(\mathcal{N}(x_0)) = \{\mathbb{R}\}$ (in the usual topology). Can such a map be continuous at x_0 ?

Exercise 1.4. Over $\mathbb{R}$ define the following EBR:

$$x \sim y \Leftrightarrow x, y \in \mathbb{Z} \vee x = y.$$

Find a subset S of $\mathbb{R}^2$ such that $S \simeq \mathbb{R} / \sim$.

Topological properties

TODO: Stupid definitions?

Definition 2.0.1: Topological property

A predicate P over topological spaces is called a **topological property** if homeomorphic spaces have the same truth value under P .

In simpler terms: P is a topological property if whenever X is homeomorphic to Y we have that X satisfies P if and only if Y satisfies P .

Definition 2.0.2: Fully hereditary

We say that a property P is **fully hereditary** if whenever X satisfies it then every subspace satisfies it too.

Rarely is a property fully hereditary.

Definition 2.0.3: Weakly hereditary

We say that a property P is **weakly hereditary** if whenever X satisfies it then every closed subspace satisfies it too.

Definition 2.0.4: Productory

We say that a property P is **productory** if whenever a collection of spaces $\{X_i\}_{i \in I}$ then the product $\prod X_i$ satisfies it too.

Definition 2.0.5: Strongly productory

We say that a property P is **strongly productory** if it's productory and whenever a product of spaces satisfies P then every factor in the product satisfies it too.

2.1 Separation axioms

Definition 2.1.1: Separation axioms

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We say that X is

- T_0 (or **Kolmogorov**) if for all $x, y \in X$ distinct there exist an open set U such that one of x, y is in U and the other one isn't.
- T_1 (or **Frechet**) if for all $x, y \in X$ distinct there exist 2 open sets U and V such that $x \in U, y \notin U$ and $x \notin V, y \in V$.
- T_2 (or **Hausdorff**) if for all $x, y \in X$ distinct there exist 2 open sets U and V such that $x \in U, y \in V$ and $U \cap V = \emptyset$.
- **regular** if for all $x \in X$ and closed sets $F \subset X$ with $x \notin F$ there exist 2 open sets U and V such that $x \in U, F \subset V$ and $U \cap V = \emptyset$.
- T_3 if it's regular and T_1 .
- **normal** if for all closed sets $F, G \subset X$ with $F \cap G = \emptyset$ there exist 2 open sets U and V such that $F \subset U, G \subset V$ and $U \cap V = \emptyset$.
- T_4 if it's normal and T_1 .

These are more-or-less standard notation. A bit less standard notation is these ones:

Definition 2.1.2: More separation axioms

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We say that X is

- **completely Hausdorff** (or completely T_2) if for every $x, y \in X$ distinct there exists a continuous function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ (in the euclidean topology) such that $f(x) = 0$ and $f(y) = 1$.
- **Tychonoff** (or **completely regular** or $T_{3\frac{1}{2}}$) if it's T_1 and if for every $x \in X$ and $C \subset X$ closed nonempty set with $x \notin C$ there exists a continuous function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $f(x) = 1$ and $f(C) = \{0\}$.

Theorem 2.1.1. $T_6 \Rightarrow T_5 \Rightarrow T_{4\frac{1}{2}} \Rightarrow T_4 \Rightarrow T_{3\frac{1}{2}} \Rightarrow T_3 \Rightarrow T_2 \Rightarrow T_1 \Rightarrow T_0$

It is of note that T_3 doesn't imply completely Hausdorff, as the next example implies:

Example 2.1.1.

Tychonoff spaces are really interesting.

Theorem 2.1.2. A space X is Tychonoff if and only if there exists some base of cozeros.

Theorem 2.1.3. Let X be a space with a base $\mathcal{B}$ of cardinal $\leq \kappa$. Then X is completely regular if and only if X can be embedded in $[0, 1]^\kappa$.

Expressing this with weights:

Theorem 2.1.4. Let X be a topological space with weight $w(X) = \kappa$. Then X is Tychonoff if and only if X can be embedded in $[0, 1]^\kappa$.

2.2 Cardinal invariants

Definition 2.2.1: Weight

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We define the **weight** of X to be the smallest infinite cardinal α for which there exists a base $\mathcal{B}$ of X with $|\mathcal{B}| = \alpha$. It is denoted by $w(X)$.

Definition 2.2.2: Character

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We define the **character of a point** $x \in X$ to be the smallest infinite cardinal α for which there exists a neighborhood base $\mathcal{B}$ of x with $|\mathcal{B}| = \alpha$, and is denoted by $\chi(x, X)$. The **character** of X is defined to be $\chi(X) = \sup\{\chi(x, X) : x \in X\}$.

Only allowing infinite cardinals makes arithmetic with these cardinal invariants a bit easier to handle.

There's a problem when working with these invariants: they require the axiom of choice to exist, as the next theorem entails:

Theorem 2.2.1. (AC) Every set of cardinal numbers is well-ordered. That is to say it has a minimum element.

However, not every case needs the axiom of choice:

Definition 2.2.3: Numerability axioms

- If $w(X)$ is countable, then X is said to be **2AN**.
- If $\chi(X)$ is countable, then X is said to be **1AN**.

The countable cardinal is the minimum in any set of infinite cardinals, so for example we already know the set of the cardinals associated with the bases of a topological space that has a countable base will have countable weight.

As we will see when we talk about convergence, 1AN is an important axiom when talking about convergent sequences in an space.

Theorem 2.2.2. $w(x) \geq \chi(X)$.

Theorem 2.2.3. $\chi(X)|X| \geq w(X)$.

Theorem 2.2.4. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a base over X . Then there exists a base $\mathcal{B}' \subset \mathcal{B}$ such that $|\mathcal{B}'| = w(X)$.

2.3 Connectedness

Definition 2.3.1: Connected space

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We say that X is **connected** if $X = A \cup B$ with $A, B \in \tau$ and $A \cap B = \emptyset$ imply that either $A = X$ or $B = X$. Equivalently, if the only partition of X into two open disjoint sets is the trivial partition $\{X, \emptyset\}$.

Theorem 2.3.1. X is connected if and only $\tau \cap \mathcal{F} = \{\emptyset, X\}$ (the only open and closed sets are $\emptyset$ and X).

Theorem 2.3.2. Being a connected space is a topological property.

The definition of connectedness concerns only partitions into 2 sets. We can expand it to arbitrary collections:

Theorem 2.3.3. Let (X, τ) be connected and $X = \bigcup_{i \in I} U_i$ a partition of X into disjoint open sets U_i , with I an arbitrary index set. Then $U_i = \emptyset$ for all $i \in I$ but one $i_0 \in I$, for which we have $U_{i_0} = X$.

The converse is not needed.

When talking about the connectedness of subspaces associated with subsets of a topological space, we use the term connected set to mean that the subspace associated with it is connected. Given connected subsets, we can obtain new connected sets from them:

Theorem 2.3.4. Let S be a connected set and $S \subset H \subset \text{Cl}(S)$. Then H is connected.

Theorem 2.3.5. Let $\{S_i\}_{i \in I}$ be a collection of connected sets such that there exists $j \in I$ with $S_i \cap S_j \neq \emptyset$ for all $i \in I$. Then $\bigcup_{i \in I} S_i$ is connected.

Definition 2.3.2: Connected component

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. A **connected component** of X is a connected subspace $C \subseteq X$ such that for all $C \subsetneq A \subseteq X$ we have that A is not connected.

Theorem 2.3.6. Every connected component is a closed subset.

Theorem 2.3.7. The set of all connected components of a space X is a partition of X .

Theorem 2.3.8. Let $x \in X$ be a point in a topological space. Then x is contained in exactly one connected component, denoted by C_x which is exactly the union of all connected subsets that contain x .

Theorem 2.3.9. If $f : (X, \tau) \rightarrow (Y, \tau')$ is continuous then $f(C_x) \subset C_{f(x)}$.

Theorem 2.3.10. The number of connected components is a topological property.

Definition 2.3.3: Path

Let X be a space. A **path** from $x_0 \in X$ to $x_1 \in X$ is a continuous function $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ such that $f(0) = x_0$ and $f(1) = x_1$. If such a function is an embedding, then f is also called an **arc**.

The interval $[0, 1]$ here is chosen for comfortability. Any other compact interval suffices. TODO: Also do something about arc connected?

Definition 2.3.4: Path connectedness

Let (X, τ) be a topological space. We say that X is **path connected** if for all $x, y \in X$ there exists a path between x and y .

Theorem 2.3.11. An open connected set in $\mathbb{R}^n$ with the euclidean topology is path connected.

2.4 Compactness

Theorem 2.4.1. A compact Hausdorff space is T_4 .

2.5 Miscellaneous properties

Of course, we have not listed every topological property. Other, less important, examples of properties are listed here.

Definition 2.5.1: Fixed point property

An space X is said to have the **fixed point property** (or to be **FPP**) if for every continuous function $f : X \rightarrow X$ there exists $x \in X$ such that $f(x) = x$ (that is to say every continuous function has a fixed point). It is a topological property.

Theorem 2.5.1. Every FPP space is connected.

The converse is false (as can be seen with $(0, 1)$ in the euclidean topology). The problem of finding equivalent conditions for FPP is pretty hard.

2.6 Problems and exercises

Exercise 2.1. Prove theorem (2.5.1).

Exercise 2.2. Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{B}$ a base of X . Prove that the following condition:

*If $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ is a cover of X with basic sets (that is $\cup_{A \in \mathcal{O}} A = X$)
then $\mathcal{O}$ contains a finite subcover of X (that is a finite $J \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ such that $\cup_{A \in J} A = X$)*

is equivalent to X being compact.

Metric spaces

3.1 Basic properties

Theorem 3.1.1. Let (Y_i, d_i) be a metric space for every $i \in \mathbb{N}$, such that there exists some $r \in \mathbb{R}$ with $d_i(x, y) < r$ for every $i \in \mathbb{N}$ and $x, y \in Y_i$ (that is, every Y_i is bounded with a common bound). Then for the product $\prod Y_i$, the function

$$d(x, y) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} 2^{-n} d_n(x_n, y_n)$$

is a metric which is compatible with the product topology.

3.2 Completeness

3.3 Metrizable spaces

Definition 3.3.1: Metrizable space

A topological space (X, τ) is said to be **metrizable** if there exists a metric d on X such that the topology generated by d is equal to τ . It is a topological property.

Theorems that guarantee metrizability under certain conditions are known as metrization theorems (fitting name). With the theory developed until here we can provide one:

Theorem 3.3.1 (Urysohn Metrization Theorem). A second countable T_3 space is metrizable.

Proof. Second countable and T_3 imply T_4 , which implies completely regular. Completely regular spaces are embeddable in $[0, 1]^\kappa$ for κ the cardinal of some base (by (2.1.3)). As our space has a countable base, it is embeddable in $[0, 1]^\mathbb{N}$ which is a metrizable space, by (3.1.1). Because subspaces of metrizable spaces are metrizable and metrizability is a topological property, the theorem is proved. $\square$

Convergence and filters

Definition 4.0.1: Filter

Let X be a set and F a family of subsets of X . F is called a **filter** in X if the following conditions are satisfied:

1. $\emptyset \notin F$, $X \in F$.
2. If $A, B \in F$ then $A \cap B \in F$.
3. If $A \in F$ and $A \subset S \subset X$ then $S \in F$.

F is then a **fixed** filter if $\bigcap_{A \in F} A$ is nonempty, otherwise it is called **free**.

Given a filter F in a space X , we say that it **converges** to a point $x \in X$ if every neighborhood of x contains an element of F .

Note that conditions 1 and 2 imply that the intersection of 2 elements of the filter is always nonempty.

Definition 4.0.2: Prefilter

Let X be a set and F a family of subsets of X . F is called a **prefilter** in X if the following conditions are satisfied:

1. $\emptyset \notin F$.
2. If $A, B \in F$ then there exists some $C \in F$ such that $C \subset A \cap B$.

It is obvious that a filter is always a prefilter.

Theorem 4.0.1. The upwards closure of a prefilter is a filter, such filter is called the **generated** by the prefilter. The filter generated by a filter is the filter itself.

Example 4.0.1. The set of all neighborhoods of a point x in a space X is a filter. This is why we didn't require neighborhoods to be open.

Compactness

Section (2.4) gave an introduction to the notion of compactness. We provide a deeper exploration here.

5.1 Stone-Čech compactification

Definition 5.1.1: Compactification

Let X be a topological space. We say that a pair (Y, h) of a space Y and an embedding $h : X \rightarrow Y$ is a **compactification** of X if Y is a compact Hausdorff space and $\text{Cl}(h(X)) = Y$.

We then consider X as if it was a subset of Y , treating $h(X)$ and X as if it were the same.

Theorem 5.1.1. If there exists some compactification (Y, h) of a space X then X must be completely regular.

Proof. By theorem (2.4.1) Y must be T_4 and so by Urysohn's lemma Y is completely regular. Then X is homeomorphic to $h(X)$, which is a subset of a completely regular space and so is completely regular. $\square$

We will show 2 different compactifications: the one point (or Alexandroff) compactification, which its results are on the exercise section, and the Stone-Čech compactification. There's 2 ways to motivate the Stone-Čech compactification of a space: one is finding a compactification such that all mappings from X to compact spaces can be extended (in some way) to the compactification and another one is finding a “maximal” compactification. We expose both of them, but build the compactification via the first way of thinking. First, we need to define a notion of extending continuous functions from subspaces to the parent space.

Definition 5.1.2: C-embedded

Let X be a topological space, and $S \subset X$. We say that S is **C-embedded** (resp. C^* -embedded) if for every $f \in C(S)$ (resp. $C^*(S)$) there exists some $g \in C(X)$ (resp. $C^*(X)$) such that $g|_S = f$.

If S is dense in X , then theorem (TODO: reference) tells us that the continuous extension is unique. This implies that $C(S)$ embeds into $C(X)$ as rings, via the application that sends each continuous function to its unique extension. So if X is some compactification of S such that S is C -embedded we have that $C(S)$ embeds into $C(X)$. The same applies to $C^*(S)$ and $C^*(X)$.

Theorem 5.1.2 (Urysohn extension). S is a C^* -embedded subset of X if and only if every pair of subsets that can be separated by continuous functions in S can be separated by continuous functions in X .

Proof. The direct implication is consequence of the definitions. For the converse, let f be a continuous bounded function $f : S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, let $\alpha > 0$ be an upper bound for the absolute value of f , and let $r_n = \frac{\alpha}{2}(\frac{2}{3})^n$ for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$. We notice that $|f(s)| \leq 3r_1$ for all $s \in S$. We search for an extension of f to the entire space X . To that end, we proceed by induction. Suppose we have $n + 1$ functions $f_m : S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ for $m = 0$ integer to n and another n functions $g_m : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ for $m = 0$ integer to $n - 1$ that satisfy

$$\begin{aligned} |f_m(s)| &\leq 3r_m \quad \forall s \in S \quad \forall m, \\ |g_m(x)| &\leq r_m \quad \forall x \in X \quad \forall m, \\ f_{m+1} &= f_m - g_m|_S \quad \forall m \in \{n-1, \dots, 0\}. \end{aligned}$$

Our base case is covered by letting $f_1 = f_0 = f$ and $g_0 = 0$. Let

$$\begin{aligned} A_n &= \{x \in S : f_n(x) \leq -r_n\}, \\ B_n &= \{x \in S : f_n(x) \geq r_n\}. \end{aligned}$$

It is easily checked that A_n and B_n are separated by continuous functions in S , via the function (TODO: Write the function). By the hypothesis A_n and B_n are separated by continuous functions in X , and so there exists some continuous bounded function $g_n : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $g_n(A_n) = \{-r_n\}$, $g_n(B_n) = \{r_n\}$ and $|g_n(x)| \leq r_n$ for all $x \in X$. We can now define the continuous function $f_{n+1} : S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ via

$$f_{n+1} = f_n - g_n|_S, \tag{5.1}$$

and notice that, for $x \in S$:

1. If $x \in A_n$ then $|f_{n+1}(x)| = |f_n(x) - g_n(x)| = |f_n(x) + r_n| \leq 2r_n$ because $-3r_n \leq f_n(x) \leq -r_n$.
2. If $x \in B_n$ then $|f_{n+1}(x)| = |f_n(x) - g_n(x)| = |f_n(x) - r_n| \leq 2r_n$ because $r_n \leq f_n(x) \leq 3r_n$.
3. If $x \notin A_n$ and $x \notin B_n$ then $|f_{n+1}(x)| = |f_n(x) - g_n(x)| \leq 2r_n$ because $f_n(x) \in]-r_n, r_n[$ and $g_n(x) \in [-r_n, r_n]$.

So $|f_{n+1}(x)| \leq 2r_n = 2 * \frac{\alpha}{2}(\frac{2}{3})^n = 3r_{n+1}$ for all $x \in S$. By induction we have built two sequences of functions $f_n : S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with $|f_n(x)| \leq 3r_n$ and $g_n : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with $|g_n(x)| \leq r_n$. By Weierstrass M-Test, the series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} g_n$ converges to some continuous function g on X , and using (5.1) with some $x \in S$ we observe that:

$$\sum_{n=1}^m g_n(x) = \sum_{n=1}^m (f_n(x) - f_{n+1}(x)) = f_1(x) - f_{m+1}(x).$$

Because of $|f_n(x)| \leq 3r_n$ we obtain that on S , $\sum_{n=1}^m g_n(x)$ converges to $f_1 = f$ and so $g = f$ on S . $\square$

This theorem tells us that to prove that a subset is C^* -embedded we don't have to consider every mapping, we only have to consider the ones that separate sets.

Definition 5.1.3: Rings of continuous functions

Let X be a topological space, and

$$C(X) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} : f \text{ is continuous}\},$$

$$C^*(X) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} : f \text{ is continuous and bounded}\}.$$

Then $C(X)$ and $C^*(X)$ are rings with the usual addition and multiplication of real valued functions.

Theorem 5.1.3. (AC) On the set $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$ of maximal ideals of $C^*(X)$ we define the sets $\mathcal{B}_f := \{\mathfrak{m} \in \text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X)) \mid f \notin \mathfrak{m}\}$ for every $f \in C^*(X)$. The collection $\{\mathcal{B}_f\}_{f \in C^*(X)}$ forms a base for a topology, the **Zariski topology**. This topology makes the space $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$ compact.

Proof. First of all we note that $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$ is not empty thanks to Krull's theorem (every proper ideal of a nonzero commutative ring is contained in a maximal ideal, and $C^*(X)$ is nonzero due to it having 1, the constant function $f(x) = 1 \forall x \in X$). To show that the set $\{\mathcal{B}_f\}_{f \in C^*(X)}$ is a base, we use the definition of a base (1.1.3). As all elements of $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$ are proper ideals, we have $1 \notin \mathfrak{m}$ for every $\mathfrak{m} \in \text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$, so $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X)) = \mathcal{B}_1$. This proves the first condition of being a base. For the second condition, I leave the reader to prove $\mathcal{B}_f \cap \mathcal{B}_g = \mathcal{B}_{fg}$. This can be done easily using that every maximal ideal is prime.

Now, to show that this space is compact we use the condition in exercise (2.2). Suppose that $\{\mathcal{B}_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a covering of $\text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$ by basic sets, where $I \subseteq C^*(X)$. If the ideal generated by I was not equal to $C^*(X)$, then by Krull's theorem it would be contained in a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_I$ such that $I \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_I$ so that $\mathfrak{m}_I$ would not be in the union of $\{\mathcal{B}_i\}_{i \in I}$, contradicting the fact that it was a basic cover. As such, the ideal generated by I is equal to $C^*(X)$ and so there exists some finite subset $J \subseteq I$ such that a finite sum $\sum_{j \in J} \alpha_j j = 1$ is achieved for some functions $\alpha_j \in C^*(X)$. If an ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ were to not be found in $\cup_{j \in J} \mathcal{B}_j$ then $j \in \mathfrak{m}$ for all $j \in J$ and thus $1 \in \mathfrak{m}$, so $\mathfrak{m} \notin \text{MaxSpec}(C^*(X))$. $\{\mathcal{B}_j\}_{j \in J}$ is then a finite subcover. $\square$

This last theorem actually applies to any commutative nonzero ring instead of $C^*(X)$.

Theorem 5.1.4. (AC) Let R be a nonzero commutative ring. On the set $\text{MaxSpec}(R)$ of maximal ideals of R we define the sets $\mathcal{B}_f := \{\mathfrak{m} \in \text{MaxSpec}(R) \mid f \notin \mathfrak{m}\}$ for every $f \in R$. The collection $\{\mathcal{B}_f\}_{f \in R}$ forms a base for a topology, the **Zariski topology**. This topology makes the space $\text{MaxSpec}(R)$ compact.

Proof. First of all we note that $\text{MaxSpec}(R)$ is not empty thanks to Krull's theorem (every proper ideal of a nonzero commutative ring is contained in a maximal ideal). To show that the set $\{\mathcal{B}_f\}_{f \in R}$ is a base, we use the definition of a base (1.1.3). As all elements of $\text{MaxSpec}(R)$ are proper ideals, we have $1 \notin \mathfrak{m}$ for every $\mathfrak{m} \in \text{MaxSpec}(R)$, so $\text{MaxSpec}(R) = \mathcal{B}_1$. This proves the first condition of being a base. For the second condition, I leave the reader to prove $\mathcal{B}_f \cap \mathcal{B}_g = \mathcal{B}_{fg}$. This can be done easily using that every maximal ideal is prime.

Now, to show that this space is compact we use the condition in exercise (2.2). Suppose that $\{\mathcal{B}_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a covering of $\text{MaxSpec}(R)$ by basic sets, where $I \subseteq R$. If the ideal generated by I was not equal to R , then by Krull's theorem it would be contained in a maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}_I$ such that $I \subseteq \mathfrak{m}_I$ so that $\mathfrak{m}_I$ would not be in the union of $\{\mathcal{B}_i\}_{i \in I}$, contradicting the fact that it was a basic cover. As such, the ideal generated by I is equal to R and so there exists some finite subset $J \subseteq I$ such that a finite sum $\sum_{j \in J} \alpha_j j = 1$ is achieved for some elements $\alpha_j \in R$. If an ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ were to not be found in $\cup_{j \in J} \mathcal{B}_j$ then $j \in \mathfrak{m}$ for all $j \in J$ and thus $1 \in \mathfrak{m}$, so $\mathfrak{m} \notin \text{MaxSpec}(R)$. $\{\mathcal{B}_j\}_{j \in J}$ is then a finite subcover. $\square$

Theorem 5.1.5. TODO: Does it work with Tychonoff spaces?

Let X and Y be compact Hausdorff spaces. Then X is homeomorphic to Y if and only if $C(X)$ is isomorphic to $C(Y)$ as rings.

This looks like a pretty strong characterization of homeomorphic spaces. In practice, calcu-

lating $C(X)$ is near impossible. In section (5.2) we provide a way of getting a ring isomorphic to $C(X)$, which may prove useful (it won't).

5.2 Rings of continuous functions

Definition 5.2.1: Rings of continuous functions

Let X be a topological space, and

$$C(X) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} : f \text{ is continuous}\},$$

$$C^*(X) := \{f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R} : f \text{ is continuous and bounded}\}.$$

Then $C(X)$ and $C^*(X)$ are rings with the usual addition and multiplication of functions. Moreover, $C^*(X)$ is a Banach algebra with the usual scalar multiplication and the norm

$$\|f\| = \sup_{x \in X} |f(x)|,$$

while $C(X)$ is a complete metric space under the metric

$$d(f, g) = \sup_{x \in X} \frac{|f(x) - g(x)|}{1 + |f(x) - g(x)|}.$$

Now, we want to know what kind of spaces we can study with rings of functions.

Theorem 5.2.1. For every space X there exists some completely regular space tX such that:

1. tX is a continuous image of X under some mapping t .
2. For every continuous function $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, there exists some continuous function $t(f) : tX \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{t} & tX \\ & \searrow f & \downarrow t(f) \\ & & \mathbb{R} \end{array}$$

3. $C(X) \cong C(tX)$ and $C^*(X) \cong C^*(tX)$.

Proof. Define over X the following EBR:

$$x \sim y \Leftrightarrow f(x) = f(y) \quad \forall f \in C(X).$$

Let tX be the set of all equivalence classes and $t : X \rightarrow tX$ the canonical projection. Given $f \in C(X)$ we define the map $t(f)$ by $t(f) \circ t = f$, which is a well defined map: if $[x] = [y]$ then $t(f)([x]) = t(f)(t(x)) = f(x) = f(y) = t(f)(t(y)) = t(f)([y])$. We equip tX with the initial topology given by all the $t(f)$ (that is, the coarsest topology such that all $t(f)$ are continuous). This obviously makes the diagram above commute, and makes t a continuous map.

Now, to prove tX is completely regular we will first show it is completely Hausdorff. If $[x] \neq [y]$ for some elements $[x], [y] \in tX$ then by definition there must exist $f \in C(X)$ such that $f(x) \neq f(y)$, which means that $t(f)([x]) \neq t(f)([y])$, where we can construct a mapping that separates $[x]$ and $[y]$. Because tX is completely Hausdorff, it is T_1 . To see that it is completely regular, let F be a closed set in tX and $[y] \notin F$. Because we have given tX the final topology generated by the $t(f)$, there exists a collection of closed sets $\{F_f\}_{f \in C(X)}$ in $\mathbb{R}$ (of which many may be equal to $\mathbb{R}$) such that $F = \bigcap (t(f))^{-1}(F_f)$. Because $[y] \notin F$ there must exist some $f_0 \in C(X)$ such that

$[y] \notin (t(f_0))^{-1}(F_{f_0})$, and so $t(f_0)([y]) \notin F_{f_0}$. Because $\mathbb{R}$ is completely regular, there exists g that separates $t(f_0)([y])$ and F_{f_0} and so $g \circ t(f_0)$ separates $[y]$ and $F \subseteq (t(f_0))^{-1}(F_{f_0})$.

Finally, we prove that the map $f \rightarrow t(f)$ is a ring and lattice isomorphism of $C(X)$ and $C^*(X)$.
 TODO, Weak topology? □

Note that in the theorem, tX is not given the quotient topology, as in general it may not be equal to the initial topology of all the $t(f)$.

This theorem effectively says that we can't distinguish separation properties that are completely regular or lesser using these rings, as there will always exist an space that carries essentially the same information that is completely regular.

The fundamental group

Something we have been unable to do at this point is find out if $\mathbb{R}^2$ and $\mathbb{R}^3$ are homeomorphic. Back when we learned about connectedness, we were able to prove that $\mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbb{R}^2$ were not homeomorphic by seeing what happens to both space when we prick a hole in them. Running through our topological invariants lists with the perforated $\mathbb{R}^2$ and $\mathbb{R}^3$ we see that they do have the same invariants. In this chapter we will see that these two holes are actually of a different topological nature, and we can use this same method to prove that $\mathbb{R}^2$ and $\mathbb{R}^3$ are not homeomorphic. Later, we will be able to generalize this to $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $\mathbb{R}^m$ for arbitrary n, m (much later). This will also yield a whole lot of interesting topology.

The basic idea is this: if we have a loop L in $\mathbb{R}^2 \setminus \{(0, 0)\}$ such that $(0, 0)$ is in the (intuitive) interior of L then we can't continuously deform L into a point (because eventually the loop will hit $(0, 0)$ but it can't pass through there), while in $\mathbb{R}^3 \setminus \{(0, 0)\}$ we can. One can think of a loop in any space as the continuous image of S^1 , and the act of deformation as a certain continuous map $F : S^1 \times [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ that for every $t \in [0, 1]$ gives us a loop $F(\cdot, t)$ of the process of deformation, such that the image of $F(\cdot, 0)$ is L and the image of $F(\cdot, 1)$ is a single point. This proves that this process is topological, and so we should be able to get a topological invariant out of it.

6.1 Path homotopy

In this section X and Y will denote topological spaces.

Definition 6.1.1: Path space

The set of all paths from x to y in a space X is called the **path space**, and is denoted by $\Omega_{x,y}$. An element of $\Omega_{x,x}$ is called a **loop**, and $\Omega_{x,x}$ is the **loop space** based at x .

It is of note that loop and continuous maps from S^1 to X are equivalent concepts.

Definition 6.1.2: Concatenation of paths

Given paths $\alpha \in \Omega_{x,y}$ and $\beta \in \Omega_{y,z}$ their **concatenation** is a path from x to z given by

$$\alpha * \beta = \begin{cases} \alpha(2t) & 0 \leq t \leq \frac{1}{2} \\ \beta(2t - 1) & \frac{1}{2} \leq t \leq 1 \end{cases}$$

Is it easy to see, by using the gluing lemma, that $\alpha * \beta$ is continuous and so is a path from x to z .

We now need to formalize the concept of continuous deformation of paths.

Definition 6.1.3: Path homotopy

Let $x, y \in X$ and $\alpha, \beta \in \Omega_{x,y}$. We say that α is **homotopic** to β if there exists some continuous function $F : [0, 1]^2 \rightarrow X$ that satisfies:

- $F(t, 0) = \alpha(t)$ for all $t \in [0, 1]$.
- $F(t, 1) = \beta(t)$ for all $t \in [0, 1]$.
- $F(0, s) = x$ for all $s \in [0, 1]$.
- $F(1, s) = y$ for all $s \in [0, 1]$.

Such a function is called a **homotopy** between α and β .

Theorem 6.1.1. Being homotopic is an equivalence relation on any path space. The quotient set of this relation is denoted by $\overline{\Omega}_{x,y}$.

Theorem 6.1.2. Over $\overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ we define the correspondence

$$[\alpha] * [\beta] = [\alpha * \beta]$$

which turns out to be an operation, with the following properties:

- (Associativity) For every $[f], [g], [h] \in \overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ we have $[f] * ([g] * [h]) = ([f] * [g]) * [h]$.
- (Neutral element) The constant path $c(t) = x$ for all $t \in I$ is such that for every $[f] \in \overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ we have $[f] * [c] = [c] * [f] = [f]$.
- (Inverses) For every $[f] \in \overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ there exists a $[\bar{f}] \in \overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ such that $[f][\bar{f}] = [\bar{f}][f] = [c]$.

Definition 6.1.4: Fundamental group at a point

With the operation defined above, $\overline{\Omega}_{x,x}$ is a group called the **fundamental group** of X based at x , and is denoted by $\pi_1(X, x)$.

Definition 6.1.5: Induced homomorphism

If $x \in X, y \in Y$ and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a continuous function such that $f(x) = y$ then the application $\bar{f} : \pi_1(X, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y)$ defined by $\bar{f}([\alpha]) = [f \circ \alpha]$ is a group homomorphism that we call the homomorphism **induced** by f .

Theorem 6.1.3. If $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a homeomorphism and $x \in X$ then the homomorphism $\bar{f}$ induced on $\pi_1(X, x)$ by f is an isomorphism.

Theorem 6.1.4. If X is path connected for all $x, y \in X$ then $\pi_1(X, x) \cong \pi_1(X, y)$.

Definition 6.1.6: Fundamental group

If X is path connected then we say that any $\pi_1(X, x)$ is the **fundamental group** of X and we denote it by $\pi_1(X, x)$.

The 2 previous theorems imply that it is well defined and that it is a topological invariant.

Definition 6.1.7: Simply connected

If X is path connected and $\pi_1(X, x) \cong \{1\}$ (the trivial group) then X is said to be **simply connected**.

We now turn towards the task of calculating fundamental groups of some spaces. This task is, in general, pretty hard.

Example 6.1.1. If $X = \{a\}$ is a space with one point, then we can only define one path on X (the path $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ such that $f(x) = a \forall x \in [0, 1]$). Therefore X is path connected and its fundamental group is the only group with one element (which we call the trivial group).

Definition 6.1.8: Strong deformation retract

A set $A \subseteq X$ is a **retract** of X if there exists some continuous function $r : X \rightarrow A$ (known as a **retraction**) such that $r(a) = a \forall a \in A$. A is also called a **strong reformation retract** of X if there exists a continuous application $G : X \times [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ (called **strong deformation** of the identity to r) such that

- $G(x, 0) = x$ and $G(x, 1) = r(x)$ for all $x \in X$.
- $G(a, t) = a$ for all $a \in A$ and $t \in [0, 1]$.

Theorem 6.1.5. Let $A \subseteq X$ be nonempty.

- If A is a retract of X , then for every $a \in A$ the inclusion $i_A : A \rightarrow X$ induces a monomorphism between the fundamental groups $\pi_1(A, a)$ and $\pi_1(X, a)$.
- If A is a strong deformation retract of X , then for every $a \in A$ the inclusion induces an isomorphism between the fundamental groups $\pi_1(A, a)$ and $\pi_1(X, a)$.

Example 6.1.2. The set $A = \{(0, 0)\}$ (the origin) is a strong deformation retract of the open ball $X = B((0, 0), 1) \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$ with the usual topology. To see this, we consider the obvious retraction $r : A \rightarrow X$ defined by $r(x) = (0, 0) \forall x \in X$, and the strong deformation $G : X \times [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ given by $G(x, t) = (1 - t)x$. These are continuous functions, r is obviously a retraction and G satisfies:

- $G(x, 0) = (1 - 0)x = x$ and $G(x, 1) = (1 - 1)x = (0, 0) = r(x)$ for all $x \in X$.
- If $a \in A$ and $t \in [0, 1]$ then $G(a, t) = (1 - t)a = (0, 0) = a$.

So G is a strong deformation between the identity and r , so A is a strong deformation retract of X onto A . By the last theorem and A and X being path connected, the fundamental groups of A and X are isomorphic, so X has trivial fundamental group. This example can be generalized to any nonempty convex subset of $\mathbb{R}^n$ under the euclidean topology.

6.2 Covering spaces

Definition 6.2.1: Covering space

Let X and E be topological spaces, and $p : E \rightarrow X$ a continuous and surjective map. We say that p is a **covering map** and that E is a **covering space** of X if for all $x \in X$ there exists an open neighborhood U_x of x such that

$$p^{-1}(U_x) = \bigcup_{\alpha} V_{\alpha}$$

where the V_{α} are open pairwise disjoint sets on E such that $p|_{V_{\alpha}} : V_{\alpha} \rightarrow U_x$ is a homeomorphism for all α . The V_{α} sets are called **sheets** and the set $p^{-1}(\{x\})$ is called the **fiber** of x .

Covering spaces have a complex definition.

Example 6.2.1. Every topological space is a covering space of itself.

Example 6.2.2. $\mathbb{R}$ is a covering space of S^1 via the covering map $p(t) = (\cos t, \sin t)$.

Definition 6.2.2: Lifting

Let E be a covering space of X , with covering map p . Given an application $f : A \rightarrow X$ from an arbitrary set A to X we say that $g : A \rightarrow E$ is a **lifting** of f if $p \circ g = f$.

Theorem 6.2.1 (Lifting of paths). Let X, E, p be like in the prior definition. Given $x_0 \in X$ and $e_0 \in E$ with $p(e_0) = x_0$, then any path α in X starting at x_0 admits a continuous lifting β in E such that β starts at e_0 .

Theorem 6.2.2. Let X, E, p, x_0, e_0 be like in the prior theorem. Then if $F : I \times I \rightarrow X$ is a continuous map with $F(0, 0) = x_0$ then there exists a unique continuous map $G : I \times I \rightarrow E$ such that $p \circ G = F$ and $G(0, 0) = e_0$. Moreover, if F is a path homotopy then G is a path homotopy.

Theorem 6.2.3. Let X, E, p, x_0, e_0 be like in the prior theorem. The rule $\phi : \pi_1(X, x_0) \rightarrow p^{-1}(\{x_0\})$ given by

$$\phi([\alpha]) = q_{\alpha}$$

where q_{α} is the ending point of a lifting of α satisfies:

1. It is a well defined application.
2. If E is path connected then ϕ is surjective.
3. If E is simply connected then ϕ is bijective.

Theorem 6.2.4. $\pi_1(S^1) \cong (\mathbb{Z}, +)$.

Theorem 6.2.5. $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}P^2) \cong (\mathbb{Z}_2, +)$

Theorem 6.2.6. Let X, Y be topological spaces and $x \in X, y \in Y$. Then

$$\pi_1(X \times Y, (x, y)) \cong \pi_1(X, x) \times \pi_1(Y, y).$$

6.3 Seifert-Van Kampen theorem

Theorem 6.3.1 (Seifert-Van Kampen for simply connected spaces). Let X be a topological space and U, V open subsets of X such that

1. $U \cup V = X$ and $U \cap V \neq \emptyset$.
2. U, V and $U \cap V$ are path connected.
3. U and V are simply connected.

Then X is simply connected

This is a simpler version of the more general theorem.

Theorem 6.3.2. $\pi_1(S^2) \cong \{1\}$.

- **Nets:** A net is a function from a directed set to a topological space. They are generalizations of sequences, and they are usually denoted by $\{x_a\}_{a \in A}$ where A is a directed set.
- **General convergence:** A net $\{x_a\}_{a \in A}$ in a topological space X converges to a point x if for every neighborhood U of x there exists an element $b \in A$ such that for all $a \geq b$ we have $x_a \in U$. Note that in general spaces a net may converge to multiple points.
- **Limit point:** A point x is called a limit point of a subset $A \subseteq X$ if every neighborhood of x intersects A at a point different from x . This is equivalent to there existing a net fully inside A that converges to x .
- **T_1 spaces:** A topological space X is called a **T_1 space** if every subset of X that contains a finite amount of points is closed.
- **Hausdorff spaces:** A topological space X is called a **Hausdorff space** if every 2 different points x and y can be separated by neighborhoods. That is, if there exists neighborhoods of x and y respectively that are disjoint whenever $x \neq y$.

Theorem 6.3.3 (Unique convergence). If a net x_a converges in a Hausdorff space, then it converges to a unique point.

This explains to us why Hausdorff spaces are interesting to study.

Theorem 6.3.4 (Closure and base). Let $A \subseteq X$ and the topology on X be given by a base. Then $x \in \bar{A}$ iff every basic neighborhood of x intersects A .

- **Subbase of a topology:** A subbase δ for a topology over X is a set of subsets such that their union is equal to X . We then get the topology generated by δ by grabbing all the unions of finite intersections of sets in δ .
- **Subspace topology:** Let X be a topological space and let $Y \subseteq X$. Then the set $T_Y = \{Y \cap U \mid U \in T\}$ is a topology over Y called the **subspace topology**. We say that Y **inherits** the topology from X .

Theorem 6.3.5 (Open sets in subspaces relative to the super space). Let Y be an open subset in X . If U is an open subset of Y with the inherited topology from X then U is open in X too.

If we change "open" to "closed" in that theorem it would still work.

Theorem 6.3.6 (Closed sets in subspaces). Let Y be a subspace in X . Then a subset $A \subseteq Y$ is closed iff it is the intersection of a closed set in X with Y .

Theorem 6.3.7 (Closure in subspaces). Let Y be a subspace in X and $A \subseteq Y$. Then $\bar{A}$ in Y is equal to $\bar{A} \cap Y$ where this closure is in X .

We have to be careful whenever we are talking about a space and a subspace of it: a set may be closed or open in the subspace but not be in X , or viceversa.

Theorem 6.3.8 (Subspaces of Hausdorff spaces). If X is a Hausdorff space, then any subspace of it is a Hausdorff space.

- **Ordered topology:** Let $(X, <)$ be an ordered set, and let B be the collection of all open intervals of X (the ones of the form $(a, b) = \{x \mid a < x < b\}$). If X has a minimum add to B intervals of the form $[a_0, b)$ for a_0 the minimum and b any other element of the set and finally if X has maximum, those intervals of the form $(a, b_0]$ where b_0 is the maximum. This forms a base for the **ordered topology** over a set. We can get a subbase for this topology by grabbing all **rays** in the set (intervals of the form $(-\infty, a)$ and $(a, +\infty)$ for a in the set).

Theorem 6.3.9 (Subspaces of ordered spaces). Let X be an ordered space and A be a convex subset of X (that means that for every $a, b \in Y$ we have that $(a, b) \in Y$). Then, the subspace topology inherited from X to Y is the same as the ordered topology applied to Y .

- **Box and product topology:** Let $(X_i)_{i \in I}$ be an arbitrary family of topological spaces. We can put a topology over $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ two inequivalent ways:

1. Take as a base every set $\prod_{i \in I} U_i$ where U_i is open in X_i for each $i \in I$. This topology is called the **box topology**.
2. Take as a base every set $\prod_{i \in I} U_i$ where U_i is open in X_i for a finite amount of $i \in I$ and for every other i let $U_i = X_i$. This topology is called the **product topology**.

Both topologies are equal for finite products. For infinite products however, it's much more convenient to use the product topology instead of the box topology, and thus when we have a product of spaces we'll assume it has the product topology. In the infinite setting, both topologies are comparable and the box topology has more open subsets than the product topology.

If the topology on the original sets is given as a base, we can get bases for our product and box topology as follows:

1. Take as a base every set $\prod_{i \in I} B_i$ where B_i is basic in X_i for each $i \in I$. This is a base for the box topology.

2. Take as a base every set $\prod_{i \in I} B_i$ where B_i is basic in X_i for a finite amount of $i \in I$ and for every other i let $B_i = X_i$. This is a base for the product topology.

Theorem 6.3.10 (Subspaces of product and box spaces). If A_i is a subspace of X_i for every $i \in I$ then $\prod_{i \in I} A_i$ is a subspace of $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ if both are given the box topology or the product topology.

Theorem 6.3.11 (Product of Hausdorff spaces). If X_i is Hausdorff for every i then $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is Hausdorff in both the box and product topologies.

- **Metric spaces:** Given a set X and a metric d on X , we can define a topology called the **metric topology** by taking as basic elements all the open balls of points of X with radius bigger than 0. Then, a metric space is a set with this topology equipped with the metric that gives that topology. A space is called **metrizable** if there exists some metric on it's underlying set that gives the same topology.

Theorem 6.3.12 (Bounded distance). Let X be a metric space equipped with the metric d . We define the metric $\bar{d}(x, y) = \min(d(x, y), 1)$, which we call bounded metric for d . Then, $\bar{d}$ induces the same topology as d .

Theorem 6.3.13 (Comparison of metric topologies). Let d and d' be 2 metrics over a set X , and call the topologies that they generate T and T' respectively. Then, $T \subseteq T'$ iff for all $x \in X$ and $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists some $\delta > 0$ such that $B_{d'}(x, \delta) \subseteq B_d(x, \varepsilon)$

Theorem 6.3.14 (Hausdorff condition in metric spaces). Every metric space is Hausdorff.

Theorem 6.3.15 (Subspaces of metric spaces). Let Y be a subset of a metric space X . Then Y given the metric topology from the distance in X is a subspace of X .

Theorem 6.3.16 (Metrizability of products). Let $(X_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of metric spaces over a countable index set. Then the product $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is metrizable. Moreover, there exists a metric that induces the same topology as the product topology.

- **Continuous functions:** A function between topological spaces $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is called continuous if any of the following equivalent conditions hold:
 1. For every open set V in Y the preimage of V ($f^{-1}(V)$) is open in X .
 2. For every closed set V in Y the preimage of V is closed in X .
 3. If the topology on Y is given by a base, the preimage of any basic element is an open set in X .
 4. For every subset A of X , we have $f(\bar{A}) \subseteq \overline{f(A)}$

We also have local conditions. Each of the above is equivalent to these holding for every

point in the space, and a local condition holding for a point implies all the other conditions. For a point $x \in X$:

1. For every neighborhood V of $f(x)$ there exist a neighborhood U of x such that $f(U) \subseteq V$.
2. For every net x_i that converges to x we have that the net $f(x_i)$ converges to $f(x)$.

Theorem 6.3.17 (Operations on continuous functions). Let X, Y, Z be topological spaces:

1. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $g : Y \rightarrow Z$ be continuous functions. Then $g \circ f$ is continuous.
2. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be continuous and let A be a subspace of X . Then the restriction of f to A is continuous and denoted by $f|_A$.
3. Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and let B be a subspace of Y containing $f(X)$. Then the restriction of f to the range B is continuous.
4. Let $X = A \cup B$ where A and B are closed and $f : A \rightarrow Y$ and $g : B \rightarrow Y$ be two continuous functions that agree on $A \cap B$ (that means $\forall x \in A \cap B \ f(x) = g(x)$) then the function h defined on X by $h(x) = f(x) = g(x) \ \forall x \in A \cap B$, $h(y) = f(y) \ \forall y \in A - (A \cap B)$ and $h(z) = g(z) \ \forall z \in B - (A \cap B)$ is continuous.

Theorem 6.3.18 (Continuous functions on product spaces). Let $f : A \rightarrow \prod_{i \in I} X_i$ be a function between topological spaces. We can see that $f(x) = (f_i(x))_{i \in I}$ for functions $f_i : A \rightarrow X_i$. Then, in the product topology f is continuous iff f_i is continuous for every i .

- **Homeomorphisms:** A continuous function is called a homeomorphism if it's bijective and it's inverse is also continuous. If $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is continuous and injective and the function obtained by restricting the range to $f(X)$ is a homeomorphism then f is called an **embedding**.